

Podcast Generation — Instructions

Quick Start

Place these two files in a folder together:

- `podcast_transcript.md` (the conversation transcript)
- `generate_local_podcast.py` (the generator script)

Option 1: Claude Code (recommended)

Open Claude Code in that folder and say:

```
Run generate_local_podcast.py — it will detect my platform and
generate a two-voice podcast MP3 from the transcript. If anything
is missing (ffmpeg, voices), install it for me. If I'm on a Mac,
first check what premium voices I have with 'say -v ?' and pick
the most natural-sounding British male for Claude and an Indian
or distinct American male for Dharmaj. If I don't have premium
voices downloaded, tell me how to get them before running.
```

Option 2: Run directly

```
# Install ffmpeg if you don't have it
brew install ffmpeg          # macOS
# sudo apt install ffmpeg    # Linux

# Run
python3 generate_local_podcast.py
```

Getting Better Voices on macOS

The quality depends entirely on which voices you have downloaded. Default voices sound decent. Premium/Neural voices sound excellent.

To download premium voices:

1. System Settings > Accessibility > Spoken Content

2. Click "System Voice" dropdown > "Manage Voices..."
3. Download these:
 - **Daniel** (British, premium) — for Claude
 - **Rishi** (Indian English, premium) — for Dharmaj
 - If Rishi isn't available: **Alex** or **Tom** work well

After downloading, run the script again — it auto-detects premium voices.

What the Script Does

1. Parses the transcript into speaker-labelled segments
2. Detects your platform (macOS / Linux / Windows)
3. Picks the best available TTS engine:
 - macOS: Apple 'say' with neural voices (best quality)
 - Linux: piper-tts (good quality) or espeak-ng (fallback)
4. Generates audio for each segment with distinct voices
5. Combines with natural pauses between speakers
6. Outputs a single MP3 file

Customisation

Edit the CONFIG section at the top of `generate_local_podcast.py`:

- Voice names (for macOS 'say' or piper)
- Speech rates
- Pause durations between speakers
- Output filename

Output

`podcast_architecture_of_control.mp3` — approximately 20-30 minutes depending on voice speed settings.

